

Aspect ratio: The ratio between the width and height of an image or image sensor.

ATA: A standard for storage devices that lets them be treated as if they were hard drives on the system. Any ATA compatible media can be read by any ATA device.

Attachment: A file such as a photograph sent along with an e-mail message so it can be viewed or saved at the recipient's end.

Automatic exposure: A mode of camera operation in which the camera automatically adjusts the aperture, shutter speed, or both for proper exposure.

Automatic flash: An electronic flash unit with a light-sensitive cell that determines the length of the flash for proper exposure by measuring the light reflected back from the subject.

Back-lit: The subject is illuminated from behind and will be underexposed unless you use fill flash or exposure compensation.

Bandwidth: The amount of data that can be sent from one computer to another through a particular connection in a certain amount of time. The more the bandwidth available, the faster you are able to access information.

Battery Life: The maximum period of time that a battery will continue to provide power to the electronic gadget.

Bayer pattern: A pattern of red, green, and blue filters on the image sensor's photosites. There are twice as many green filters as the other colors because the human eye is more sensitive to green, and therefore green color accuracy is more important.

Bit-mapped: Images formed from pixels with each pixel a shade of gray or color. Using 24-bit colour, each pixel can be set to any one of 16 million colors.

